

Chapter 8

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet: Digital Literacy and Critical Thinking (Chapter 8)

This worksheet is designed to help you apply the concepts from Chapter 8: Digital Literacy and Critical Thinking. Complete the activities below to practice spotting fake news, fact-checking content, understanding algorithms, and using technology ethically while respecting privacy. These skills will help you navigate the online world with confidence and smarts. Let's get started.

Part 1: Identifying Fake News and Misinformation

Let's test your detective skills to spot what's real and what's not online.

- **Think of a recent viral post or story you saw on social media that seemed suspicious. Write down what it was about and one reason it might be fake (e.g., weird source, no proof).**
- **What's one quick way you can check if a story is fake? (e.g., Google the headline, check the source)**

Part 2: Fact-Checking Before Sharing Content

Practice verifying information before hitting "share" to keep your online rep solid.

- **Imagine you see a post claiming, "Free phones for teens this week only!" Write down one step you'd take to fact-check this before sharing it with friends.**
- **Why do you think it's important to fact-check before sharing something online?**

Part 3: Understanding Algorithms and How They Shape Your Online Experience

Explore how algorithms control what you see and how you can take back some control.

- **Name one app or platform you use a lot (e.g., TikTok, Instagram). What kind of content does it usually show you? (e.g., gaming vids, fashion trends)**
- **Write down one way you can "trick" the algorithm to see different content. (e.g., like posts outside your usual interests, clear search history)**

Part 4: Ethical Use of Technology and Respecting Others' Privacy

Think about how to use tech responsibly and protect privacy—yours and others'.

- **Imagine you took a funny group photo at a party. What's one thing you should do before posting it online to respect your friends' privacy?**
- **List one way you can protect your own privacy online. (e.g., strong passwords, limit who sees your posts)**

Part 5: Reflection & Goal Setting

Wrap up by reflecting on what you've learned and setting a small goal to boost your digital smarts.

- **What's one thing from this chapter that surprised you or made you think differently about being online?**
- **My Digital Literacy Goal for this week:** (e.g., "Check the source of one viral post" or "Ask permission before posting a friend's pic"):

Bonus Challenge (Optional): Try one small action from your goal or any part of this worksheet this week—like fact-checking a post, tweaking your privacy settings, or mixing up your social media activity. Write down how it felt to take that step toward being digitally smarter. Share with a friend or family member if you're comfortable!